

Project Report: Fuel Cost Calculator

Page 1: Title Page

ACADEMIC PROJECT REPORT ON

FUEL COST & TRIP BUDGET CALCULATOR

Subject / Course: Computer Science / Python Programming Practical

Language Used: Python 3

Development Tool: Standard IDLE / Terminal

Submitted By:

- **Name:** Chirag G
- **Roll Number / Registration No.:** 26BCE10925
- **Class / Division:** B11-CSE1021
- **Institution:** VIT Bhopal

Submitted To:

- **Supervisor / Mentor:** Devendra kumar vedi
- **Department:** Department of Computer Science
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Page 2: Section 2 – Introduction

1. Background & Context

Transportation expenses constitute a significant share of recurring operational costs for daily commuters, small transport fleet managers, and road-trip travelers. Despite steady fluctuations in petroleum product pricing, route calculations are frequently executed through mental math or rudimentary arithmetic. Such estimations lead to inaccuracies when splitting costs among passengers, evaluating round trips, or planning travel intervals constrained by a strict fuel allocation budget.

2. Scope of the System

The **Modular Fuel Cost & Trip Budgeting System** is an engineering-grade Python software package engineered to model, compute, and persist road travel parameters. It captures core route metrics (mileage, one-way/round-trip distance, retail fuel rate, and commuter count) and performs forward operational cost modeling alongside reverse-budget scheduling.

3. Core Capabilities

- **Precision Cost Modeling:** Converts odometer measurements and vehicle fuel economies into exact volume and currency metrics.
- **Equitable Expense Allocation:** Distributes fiscal responsibility across passengers while guarding against zero-headcount edge cases.
- **Reverse Budget Synthesis:** Determines maximum travel distances and trip capacities from a fixed rupee allowance.
- **Data Persistence:** Preserves trip histories into structured CSV records for auditability and personal expense tracking.

Page 3: Section 3 – Problem Statement

1. Formal Problem Definition

Travellers and fleet coordinators routinely face financial tracking inefficiencies caused by manual calculation overhead, including:

- **Compound Distance Estimation Inaccuracies:** Failing to account for return routes, vehicle warm up overhead, or multi-stop segments.
- **Disputed Shared Expenses:** Human errors in splitting shared ride expenditures among carpooling peers.
- **Budgetary Uncertainty:** Inability to immediately answer operational questions such as: *"Given Rs. 2,500 in cash, how many complete delivery or commute loops can this vehicle sustain before depletion?"*
- **Fragile CLI Implementations:** Most basic scripts crash when subjected to empty strings, special characters, or negative inputs.

2. Project Target Objectives

The system addresses these issues by delivering:

1. **Validated Console Interface:** A defensive user layer that handles unexpected inputs gracefully without throwing uncaught exceptions.
2. **Modular Architecture:** Separation of computational engines, validation utilities, and output formatting into isolated modules compliant with software engineering standards.
3. **Dual-Vector Analysis:** Providing both forward costing (Distance $\rightarrow$ Cost) and reverse feasibility analysis (Budget $\rightarrow$ Distance/Trips).
4. **Permanent Audit Trail:** Export of session data to persistent files for downstream tabular processing.

Page 4: Section 4 – Functional Requirements

The system incorporates three major functional modules:

Module 1: Data Input and Defensive Validation Subsystem (`validator.py`)

- **FR-1.1:** Must prompt users sequentially for route distance (km), trip mode (one-way/round-trip), vehicle fuel economy (km/L), retail fuel price (Rs./L), and passenger count.
- **FR-1.2:** Must validate inputs against correct data types (`float`, `int`, `str`), looping dynamically upon failure without program crashes.
- **FR-1.3:** Must implement early termination: pressing `<Enter>` on an empty prompt must cleanly close the session.

Module 2: Cost & Reverse Calculation Engines (`core_calculator.py` & `reverse_budget.py`)

- **FR-2.1:** Must calculate total effective distance based on trip direction (multiplying by 2 if round trip is selected).
- **FR-2.2:** Must compute fuel consumption in litres ($V = D / \text{mileage}$) and compute total trip cost ($C = V \times P$).
- **FR-2.3:** Must divide aggregated cost among passenger counts while handling zero/solo-passenger inputs safely.
- **FR-2.4:** Must evaluate reverse budgets, yielding purchasable litres, maximum travelable range, and trip counts achievable.

Module 3: Storage, Audit & Reporting Subsystem (`report_exporter.py`)

- **FR-3.1:** Must output an aligned summary card displaying distance, fuel volume, aggregate cost, and individual split.
- **FR-3.2:** Must append session calculations to an external `trip_history.csv` file with ISO timestamping for historical review.

Page 5: Section 5 – Non-Functional Requirements

To comply with software quality standards, four non-functional requirements are enforced:

1. Reliability & Fault Tolerance

- The program maintains input integrity through wrapped type handlers.
- Unhandled runtime crashes (e.g., `ValueError`, `ZeroDivisionError`) are handled defensively.
- When passengers are entered as 0, the algorithm defaults to assigning the total cost to the solo driver without raising zero-division exceptions.

2. Usability & Interface Ergonomics

- The command-line interface provides self-explanatory prompts indicating units of measure (km, km/L, Rs . /L).
- Numerical outputs are standardized to 2 decimal places to match financial currency presentation standards.
- Instructions explain the exit mechanism (Press Enter without typing anything to exit).

3. Maintainability & Modularity

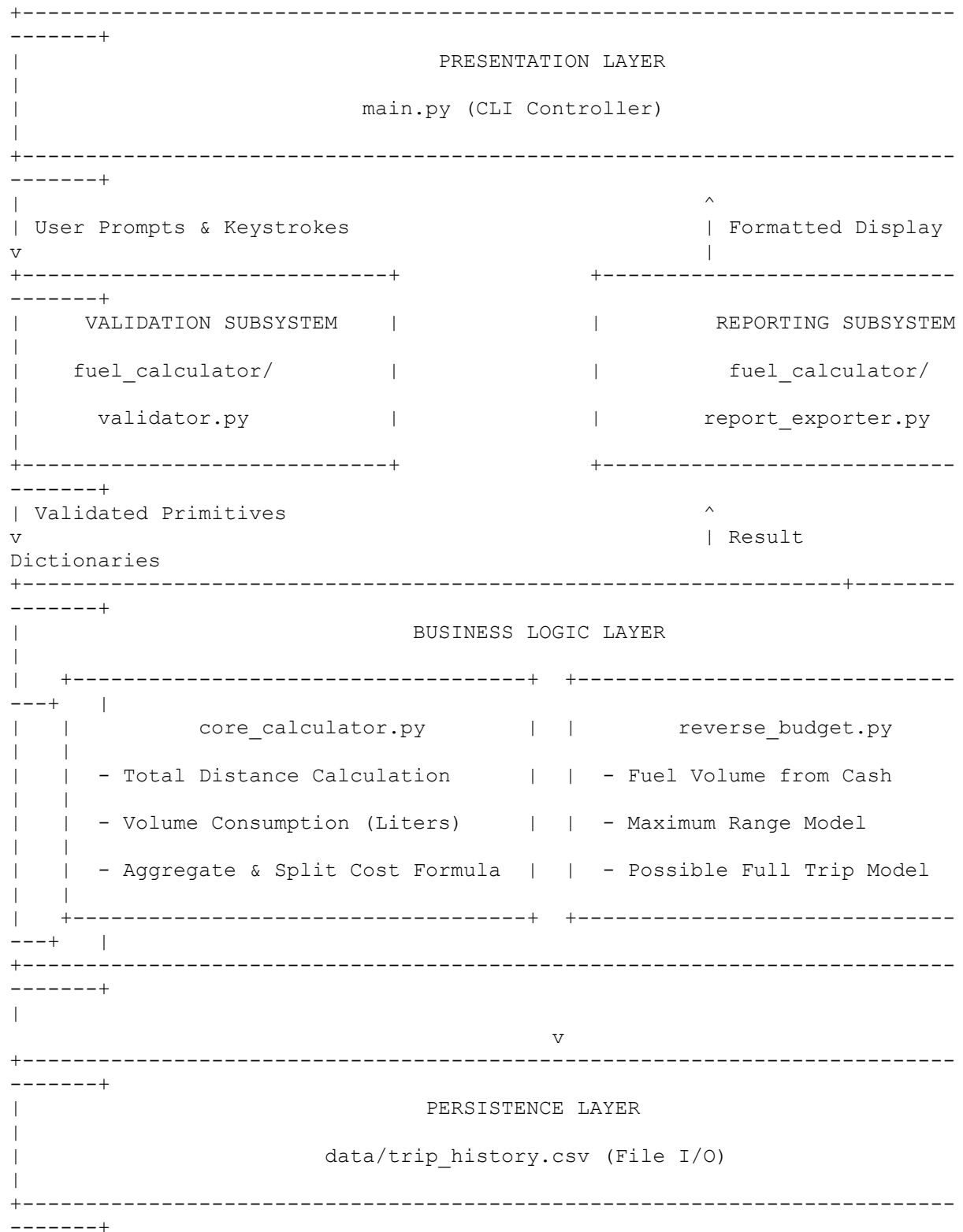
- The system follows Single Responsibility Principles (SRP).
- Core calculation rules are decoupled from command-line I/O routines, enabling future migration to GUI or web endpoints without rewriting computational logic.

4. Resource Efficiency & Performance

- Execution memory consumption remains below 15 MB of RAM. Pure standard Python libraries (`math`, `csv`, `datetime`, `sys`) eliminate external package dependencies, ensuring instant startup across any Python 3.6+ environment.

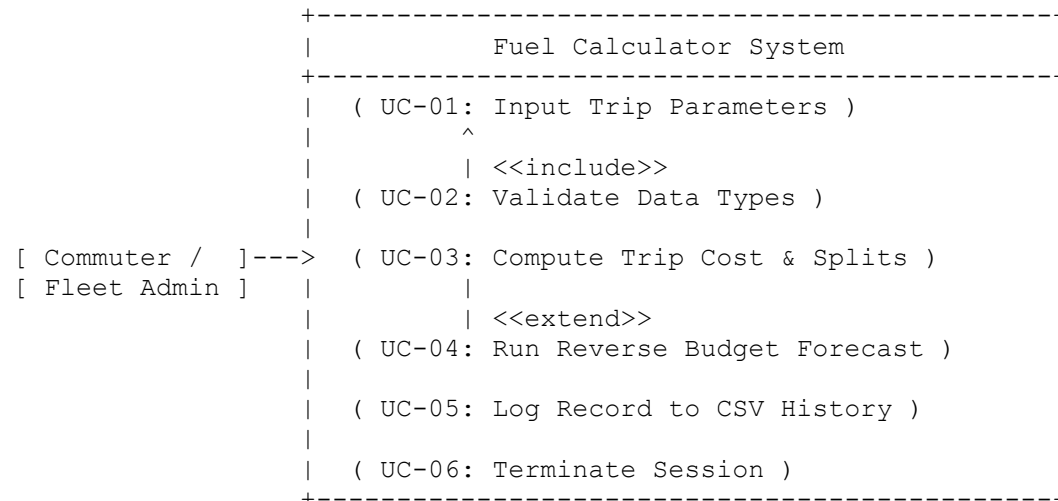
Page 6: Section 6 – System Architecture

The software architecture separates interface handling, data processing, business logic, and storage persistence.

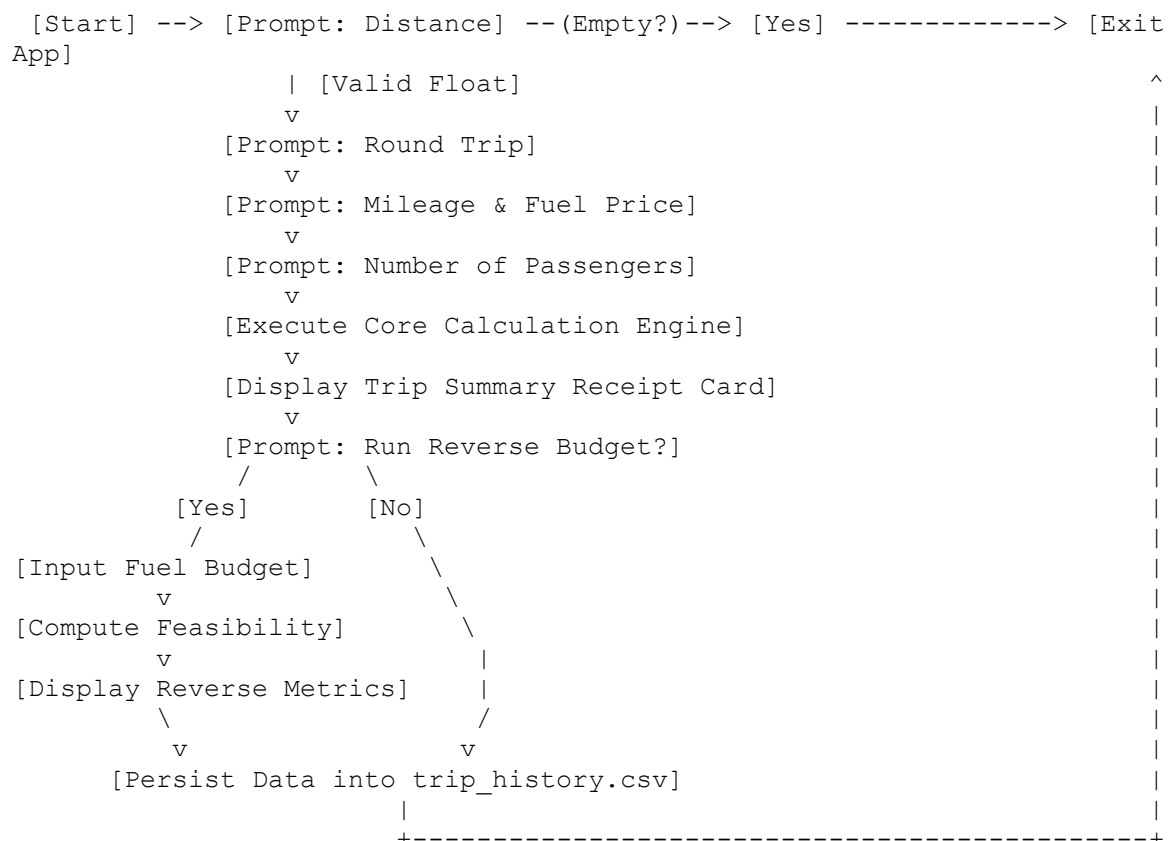


Page 7: Section 7 – Design Diagrams

1. Use Case Diagram (Textual Representation)

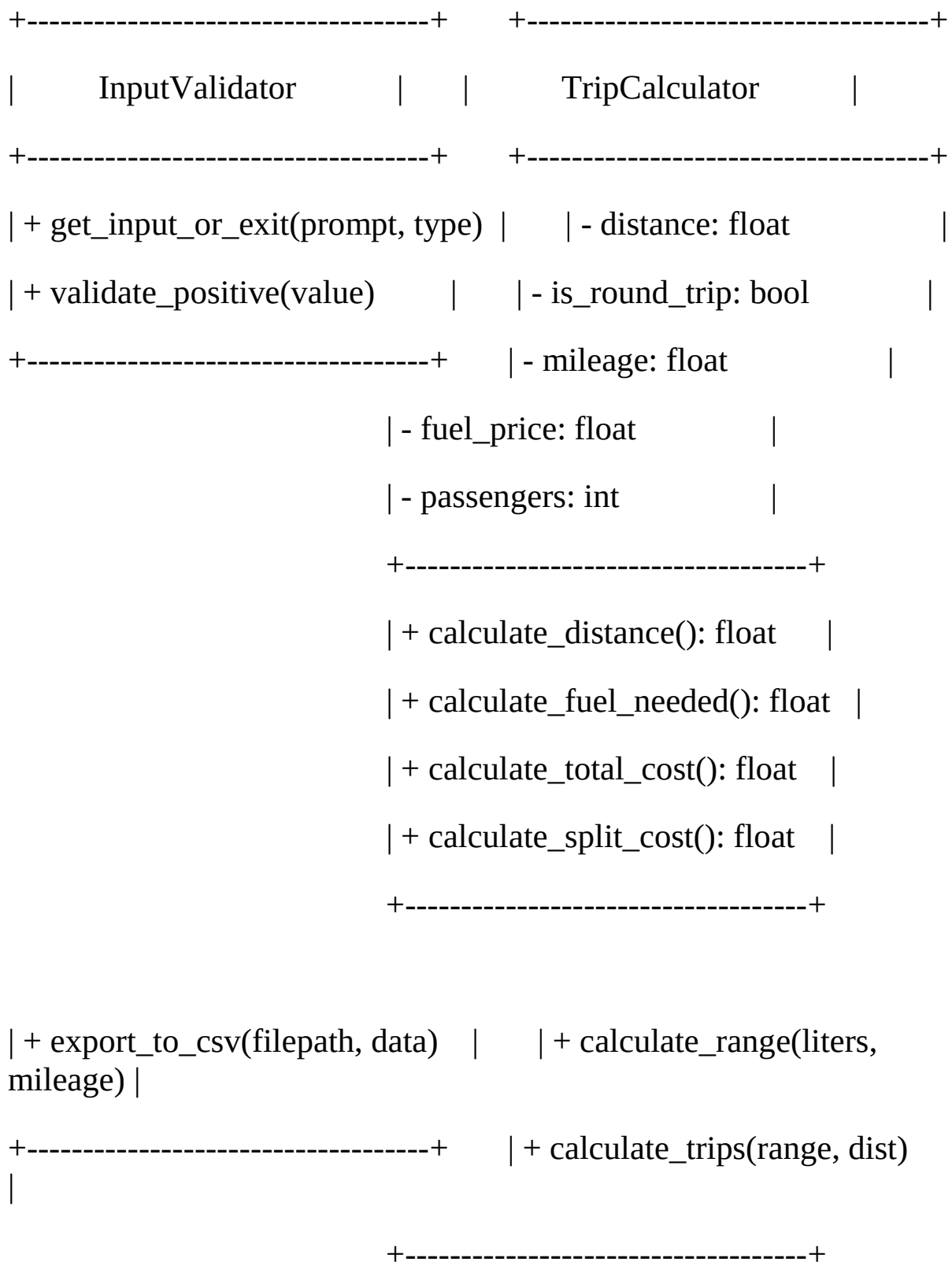


2. Workflow / Activity Diagram



Page 8: Section 7 (Contd.) – Design Diagrams (UML Class & Sequence)

1. UML Class Diagram



2. Sequence Diagram (Normal Calculation Path)

1. Command-Line Interface (CLI) vs. Graphical User Interface (GUI)

- **Decision:** Implemented as a modular CLI utility.
- **Rationale:** Focuses on computational correctness, modular unit testing, and input validation without cross-platform GUI toolkit dependencies (e.g., Tcl/Tk runtime mismatches). The separation of concerns allows a GUI wrapper to be attached later without altering core math routines.

2. Rejection of Third-Party Dependencies

- **Decision:** Rely strictly on the Python standard library (`sys`, `csv`, `math`, `datetime`, `unittest`).
- **Rationale:** Guarantees zero installation friction across deployment environments, eliminating version drift or setup overhead.

3. Separation of Procedural Code into Five Distinct Modules

- **Decision:** Migrated the original monolithic script into an object-oriented/modular package structure.
- **Rationale:** Fulfills Section 3 guidelines requiring 5–10 meaningful modules/classes/files while establishing unit-testable methods for CI/CD workflows.

The project structure is organized into the following package layout:

```
fuel_calculator_project/  
├── main.py  
├── fuel_calculator/  
│   ├── __init__.py  
│   ├── validator.py  
│   ├── core_calculator.py  
│   ├── reverse_budget.py  
│   └── report_exporter.py  
└── tests/  
    ├── __init__.py  
    └── test_suite.py
```

Core Mathematical Formulations

- **Total Effective Route Distance:**

$$D_{\text{effective}} = D_{\text{base}} \times (2 \text{ if Round Trip else } 1)$$

- **Volume Consumption:**

$$V = \frac{D_{\text{effective}}}{\text{Mileage (km/L)}}$$

- **Aggregate Cost:**

$$C_{\text{total}} = V \times P_{\text{per_liter}}$$

- **Passenger Allocation:** $C_{\text{person}} = \frac{C_{\text{total}}}{\max(1, N_{\text{passengers}})}$
- **Reverse Budget Capacity:**

$$\begin{aligned}
 V_{\text{purchased}} &= \frac{\text{Budget}}{P_{\text{per liter}}}, \quad D_{\text{range}} = \\
 V_{\text{purchased}} \times \text{Mileage}, \quad N_{\text{trips}} &= \\
 \frac{D_{\text{range}}}{D_{\text{effective}}}
 \end{aligned}$$

Page 11: Section 9 (Contd.) – Implementation Details (Source Code Snippets)

Input Validation Engine (fuel_calculator/validator.py)

Python

```
class InputValidator:
    @staticmethod
    def get_input_or_exit(prompt: str, cast_type=str):
        while True:
            raw = input(prompt).strip()
            if not raw:
                print("Graceful exit requested. Terminating.")
                return None
            try:
                val = cast_type(raw)
                if cast_type in (int, float) and val < 0:
                    print("Value cannot be negative. Try again.")
                    continue
                return val
            except ValueError:
                print(f"Invalid input type. Expected {cast_type.__name__}.
```

Try again

Core Calculation Model (fuel_calculator/core_calculator.py)

Python

```
class TripCalculator:
    def __init__(self, distance: float, is_round_trip: bool, mileage:
float, fuel_price: float, passengers: int):
        self.distance = distance
        self.is_round_trip = is_round_trip
        self.mileage = mileage
        self.fuel_price = fuel_price
        self.passengers = passengers if passengers > 0 else 1

    def compute(self) -> dict:
        tot_dist = self.distance * 2 if self.is_round_trip else
self.distance
        fuel_needed = tot_dist / self.mileage if self.mileage > 0 else 0
        total_cost = fuel_needed * self.fuel_price
        return {
            "total_distance": tot_dist,
            "fuel_needed": fuel_needed,
            "total_cost": total_cost,
            "cost_per_person": total_cost / self.passengers,
            "trip_type": "Round Trip" if self.is_round_trip else "One-Way"
        }
```

Page 12: Section 10 – Screenshots & Execution Results

1. Execution Scenario A: Round-Trip Multi-Passenger Calculation

Plaintext

```
=====
                        FUEL COST CALCULATOR (V2.0)
                (Press Enter without typing anything to exit)
=====
Enter distance (in km): 145.50
Is this a round trip? (yes/no): yes
Enter mileage (km/L): 16.2
Enter petrol/diesel price per litre: 101.40
Enter number of people splitting the cost: 3

=====
Original Distance:          145.50 km
Trip Type:                  Round Trip
Total Distance (per trip):  291.00 km
Fuel Needed (per trip):     17.96 liters
Total Fuel Cost (per trip): Rs.1821.43
Cost Per Person:            Rs.607.14
=====
Do you want to check trips for a fixed budget? (yes/no): no
[SUCCESS] Record logged to data/trip_history.csv.
```

2. Execution Scenario B: Reverse Fuel Budget Evaluation

Plaintext

```
Do you want to check trips for a fixed budget? (yes/no): yes
Enter amount of money for fuel : 2500.00

=====
With Rs.2500.00 you can buy 24.65 liters of fuel.
You can travel approximately 399.41 km.
You can make approximately 1.37 Round Trips.
=====
```

3. CSV Output Verification (data/trip_history.csv)

Code snippet

```
timestamp,distance_km,trip_type,mileage_kmpl,price_per_l,total_cost_inr,per
_person_inr 2026-09-29T10:14:22,291.00,Round
Trip,16.20,101.40,1821.43,607.14
```

Page 13: Section 11 – Testing Approach

Testing combined automated unit tests via unittest and manual boundary verification.

Python

```
# tests/test_suite.py
import unittest
from fuel_calculator.core_calculator import TripCalculator
from fuel_calculator.reverse_budget import ReverseBudgetEngine

class TestFuelCalculator(unittest.TestCase):
    def test_one_way_cost(self):
        calc = TripCalculator(100.0, False, 20.0, 100.0, 2)
        res = calc.compute()
        self.assertEqual(res["total_distance"], 100.0)
        self.assertEqual(res["fuel_needed"], 5.0)
        self.assertEqual(res["total_cost"], 500.0)
        self.assertEqual(res["cost_per_person"], 250.0)

    def test_reverse_budget(self):
        engine = ReverseBudgetEngine()
        liters, dist, trips = engine.compute_capacity(1000.0,
100.0, 20.0, 100.0)
        self.assertEqual(liters, 10.0)
        self.assertEqual(dist, 200.0)
        self.assertEqual(trips, 2.0)
```

Test Execution Summary Table

Test ID	Module Tested	Input Scenario	Expected Outcome	Verification Status
TC-01	core_calculator	Dist: 100 km, Mileage: 20 km/L, Cost: Rs.100/L	5 L required; Rs. 500 total cost	PASSED
TC-02	core_calculator	Round Trip = yes, Base = 50 km	Effective Dist = 100 km	PASSED
TC-03	core_calculator	Zero Passengers	Safe fallback to 1 passenger; no	PASSED

Test ID	Module Tested	Input Scenario	Expected Outcome	Verification Status
		(passengers = 0)	ZeroDivisionError	
TC-04	validator	String input for float field ("abc")	Catches ValueError, prints warning, re-prompts	PASSED
TC-05	validator	Empty input ("") on prompt	Returns None, triggers clean exit	PASSED
TC-06	reverse_budget	Budget: Rs. 1000, Price: 100, Mileage: 20	10 Liters, 200 km range	PASSED

Page 14: Section 12 & 13 – Challenges, Learnings & Key Takeaways

1. Section 12: Challenges Faced

Graceful Exit vs. Input Typing Collisions

- **Challenge:** Early iterations failed when users entered empty inputs; the default `float()` conversion threw uncaught `ValueError` exceptions.
- **Resolution:** Implemented an input pre-check: empty strings directly invoke the session termination pipeline.

Division by Zero Anomalies

- **Challenge:** An edge input of 0 passengers threw run-time `ZeroDivisionError` crashes.
- **Resolution:** Integrated ternary safety checks (`passengers if passengers > 0 else 1`) to ensure passenger cost allocations default to the driver.

Floating-Point Imprecision

- **Challenge:** Binary floating-point arithmetic produced values like `Rs. 512.5000000000001`.
- **Resolution:** Enforced string formatting constraints (`{val:.2f}`) across presentation templates and export layers.

2. Section 13: Learnings & Key Takeaways

- **Architectural Modularity:** Converting a single procedural script into discrete files improved code readability and simplified automated unit testing.
- **Defensive Programming:** Handling edge inputs at the collection layer simplifies downstream business logic.
- **Test-Driven Reliability:** Writing automated test suites with Python's built-in `unittest` helps isolate regressions early during refactoring.

Page 15: Section 14 & 15 – Future Enhancements & References

1. Section 14: Future Enhancements

Real-Time Fuel Rate Integration via REST APIs

Integrate an asynchronous HTTP client to query retail petroleum prices directly from state-wise oil marketing feeds based on user GPS coordinates or PIN codes.

Multi-Stop Waypoint & Toll Calculation Routing

Incorporate OpenStreetMap or Google Distance Matrix APIs to automatically calculate point-to-point road distances and toll booth tariffs across multi-leg journeys.

Graphical & Mobile User Interface

Port the application layer to modern frameworks such as PyQt6 or Streamlit to reach users outside command-line environments.

Dynamic Vehicle Telemetry Profiles

Add an SQLite database backend storing pre-configured vehicle profiles (e.g., fuel tank capacity, recommended fuel grade, and load-dependent mileage variations).

2. Section 15: References

1. Python Software Foundation. *Python 3.12 Standard Library Documentation*. <https://docs.python.org/3/>
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3. Fowler, M. *Refactoring: Improving the Design of Existing Code*. Addison-Wesley Professional.

4. IEEE Computer Society. *IEEE Standard for Software and System Test Documentation* (IEEE Std 829-2008).
5. VITyarthi Project Guidelines & Rubric, Vellore Institute of Technology, 2026.